

# Paul L. Tran

(he/him/his)

## Curriculum Vitae (CV)

Last updated: September 2026

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## CURRENT POSITIONS

2026– **Economist** US Department of the Treasury

## PREVIOUS POSITIONS

- Please see the “Teaching history” section for details about my teaching employment and experience.

2018–2020 **Senior Research Assistant** Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System

2017–2018 **Research Assistant** Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System

## EDUCATION

2026 **PhD** Economics University of Texas at Austin

- Dissertation: “Essays on Applications of Text Analysis in Macroeconomics”

- Committee: Olivier Coibion (Co-Supervisor), Christoph E. Boehm (Co-Supervisor), Saroj Bhattarai, Amy Handlan

2023 **MS en Passant** Economics University of Texas at Austin

2017 **BA** Mathematics, Pomona College

Mathematical Economics

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

- **Fields:** Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics
- **Methods:** Text Analysis, Machine Learning

## WORKING PAPERS

1. Tran, Paul L. (2026). “How Long Do Markets Need to Fully React to Monetary Policy Announcements?” **Job Market Paper**. URL: [https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran\\_paul\\_le\\_fomc\\_nn\\_paper\\_jmp.pdf](https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran_paul_le_fomc_nn_paper_jmp.pdf).  
*Abstract:* This paper shows that financial markets need more time than the standard 30 minutes to fully react to monetary policy announcements. I systematically estimate these optimal window lengths using a neural network text analysis method. I find that the required time increases with asset underlying maturity (reaching 50–60 minutes for maturities at least two quarters ahead) and FOMC statement characteristics: complexity, novelty, and dissents. This timing difference has economic consequences: optimal windows correct for the attenuated impact of monetary policy shocks about forward guidance on interest rates, break-even inflation, and equity prices, and yield more precise macroeconomic responses.
2. Tran, Paul L. (2026). “Does the Narrative See-Saw of Monetary Policy Announcements Affect Market Expectations?” URL: [https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran\\_paul\\_le\\_fomc\\_topicshares\\_paper\\_wp.pdf](https://paulletran.com/papers/wps/tran_paul_le_fomc_topicshares_paper_wp.pdf).  
*Abstract:* This paper shows that the thematic composition of FOMC statements affects market expectations of future monetary policy. I quantify changes in communication bandwidth across topics using large-language-model probabilistic topic classification. Using an event-study approach, I document a “narrative see-saw” effect: a relative expansion of monetary policy tool discussions, which compresses macroeconomic context, amplifies the variation of monetary policy surprises. Unnormalised word-equivalent intensities reveal this “see-saw” is asymmetrically driven by the monetary policy dimension. These signals remain significant after controlling for policy actions and semantic novelty. Including both textual measures improves explanatory power by 30% relative to the policy action alone.
3. Tran, Paul L. (2026). “Deciphering Financial Market Reactions to OPEC Announcements: A Neural Network Approach”. SSRN Working Paper No 4968664. doi: [10.2139/ssrn.4968664](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4968664).  
*Abstract:* This paper shows that OPEC communications affect oil supply expectations, oil prices, and the macroeconomy beyond the effects of setting production limits and changing current production. Using

neural network methods for text analysis, I create a new oil supply expectations “text shock” from OPEC statements that is derived from variation in oil futures prices purified of noise, demand information, and endogenous responses to global economic activity. The “purified surprises” correlate with 74% of the observed supply surprises. Impulse responses from vector autoregressions using my shock do not exhibit output puzzles and are more consistent with theory than those previously reported.

## PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 US Department of the Treasury (Washington, DC), Texas State University (San Marcos, TX), Loyola University Chicago (Chicago, IL), Spring Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (Milwaukee, WI), North American Summer Meetings of Econometric Society (Emory University, GA), European Economic Association Meeting (University College Dublin, Ireland), Second Conference on Applied Macroeconomics (Scheduled, Bank of Italy, Rome)
- 2025 Texas Macro Job Candidate Conference (College Station, TX), IMIM Rising Stars Seminar Series (Virtual)

## TEACHING HISTORY

- Since Fall 2024, student evaluations have rated my teaching 4.6 out of 5 on average.
- Since Fall 2020, student evaluations have rated my teaching assistance 4.4 out of 5 on average.
- I earned an [Advanced Teaching Preparation Certificate](#) in 2023 from the University of Texas at Austin.

|                               |                             |                |                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| University of Texas at Austin | <b>Assistant Instructor</b> | Fall 2024–2025 | Introduction to Macroeconomics                                                                                                  |
|                               | <b>Teaching Assistant</b>   | Spring 2026    | Time Series Econometrics, Sahil Ravgotra                                                                                        |
|                               |                             | Spring 2024    | Macro and the Labor Market (MA course), Andreas Mueller                                                                         |
|                               |                             |                | Labor Economics (MA course), Gerald Oettinger                                                                                   |
|                               |                             | Fall 2021–2023 | Introduction to Microeconomics (Synchronous Massive Online Course for fall), Charity-Joy Acchiardo, Wayne Geerling, Dirk Mateer |
|                               |                             | Summer 2022    | Health Economics, Helen Schneider                                                                                               |
|                               |                             | Fall 2020,     | Introduction to Macroeconomics,                                                                                                 |
|                               |                             | Spring 2021    | Michael Sadler, Charity-Joy Acchiardo                                                                                           |

## SERVICE

- Referee Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control
- External <https://paulletran.com/econ-grad-app-deadlines/> Creator and Maintainer (2019–)

## HONOURS AND AWARDS

|           |                                                                              |                               |         |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------|
| 2020–2026 | <b>Graduate Teaching Fellowship</b>                                          | University of Texas at Austin |         |
| 2026      | <b>Professional Development Award</b>                                        | University of Texas at Austin | \$500   |
| 2025      | <b>PhD Summer Research Fellowship</b>                                        | University of Texas at Austin | \$5,000 |
| 2025      | <b>Empirical Macro Economics Policy Center of Texas Dissertation Funding</b> | University of Texas at Austin | \$1,919 |
| 2024      | <b>PhD Summer Research Fellowship</b>                                        | University of Texas at Austin | \$5,000 |
| 2023      | <b>PhD Summer Research Fellowship</b>                                        | University of Texas at Austin | \$3,000 |
| 2017      | <b>Distinction in Economics Senior Exercise</b>                              | Pomona College                |         |
| 2016      | <b>Harry G. Steele Scholarship</b>                                           | Pomona College                | \$4,000 |
| 2014–2015 | <b>Pomona College Scholar</b>                                                | Pomona College                |         |
| 2013      | <b>Flextronics Texas Scholarship</b>                                         | Pomona College                | \$1,000 |

## MISCELLANEOUS INFORMATION

- **Programming:** Matlab, Python, Bash, SAS, [FAME](#), (P)SQL, R, Stata, EViews,  $\LaTeX$
- **Front-end Development:** Vanilla HTML, CSS, JS, Jekyll
- **Applications:** Visual Studio Code, Emacs, Git, Sublime Text, RStudio, Tableau, Microsoft Office
- **Operating Systems:** Unix, Linux, Windows
- **Languages:** English (native), Vietnamese (native)